

AI for Nonprofits

Tuesday, June 2, 2026 | 9:00 AM–3:00 PM

Hosted by Microsoft Elevate Team

Instructor: Jeremy Nathan



YOUR INSTRUCTOR



Jeremy Nathan

Employee Development Instructor



Certifications

- Microsoft Certified Trainer (MCT)
- Microsoft PL-300 Power BI Data Analyst
- Microsoft Office Specialist (MOS) Excel



Academic Credentials

- Bachelor of Science (BS) and Master of Business Administration (MBA)



Location

- Chattanooga, TN

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Today's Journey

🕒 9:00 AM – 3:00 PM

9:00	Foundations
9:20	Rewrite Practice
9:40	Fundraising & Outreach
10:30	<i>Break (15 min)</i>
10:45	Emails and Letters
11:25	Responsible AI
11:30	<i>Lunch</i>
12:30	Case Notes and translations
1:10	Reports & Excel Data
1:30	<i>Break (15 min)</i>
1:45	Annual Report Demo
2:15	Share-out & Badges

Completion badge awarded | Hands-on activities & turn-and-talks throughout

Why This Training Matters for You

- Spend less time on routine writing, reporting, and admin
- Get actionable insights from your data – faster
- Reach multilingual communities without a translation budget
- Build AI confidence across every level of your organization
- Redirect time and energy to the work that drives your mission

Washington State AI Task Force

“

This technology has the potential to provide great benefits to people if used well and to cause great harm if used irresponsibly”

State Bill SB 5838 March 4, 2024

”

How are you currently using AI?

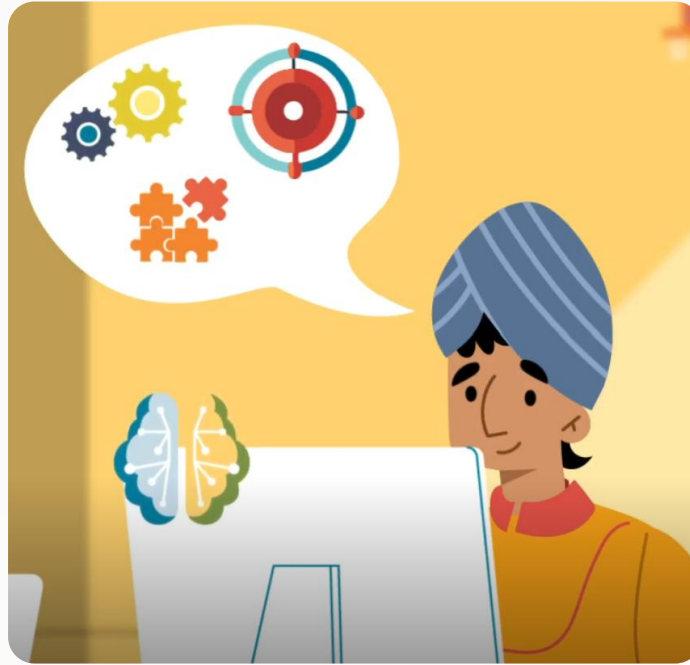
Scan the QR code or type in the code to answer this one question poll.



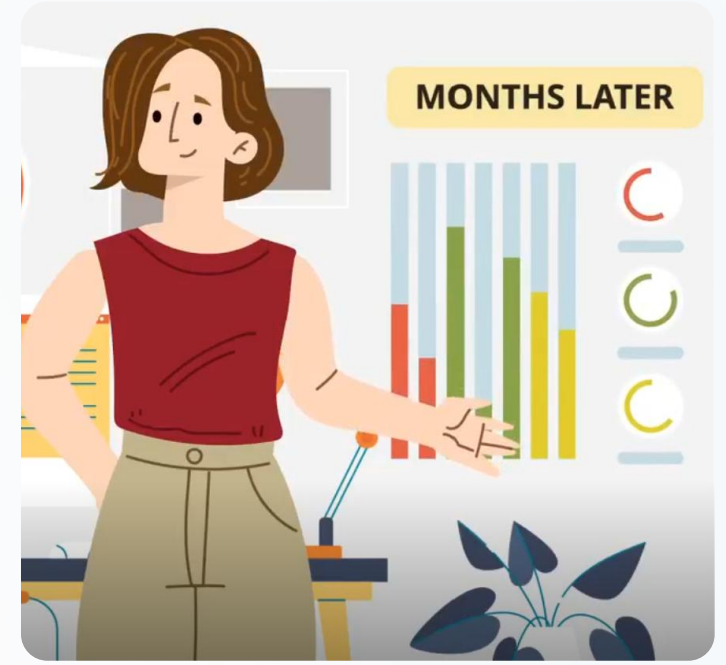
Key Humanitarian Principles



Dignity



Fairness



Accountability

How other non-profits are using AI



AI **writes** personalized donor emails and follow-ups automatically, helping increase donations while saving time – ***CCS Fundraising***



AI **analyzes** satellite and environmental data to detect disasters early and support prevention efforts – ***NOAA***



AI **chatbots** provide 24/7 support to people in need, helping them find shelter, food, and services instantly – ***UN Refugee Agency***



AI **predicts** where help will be needed next so organizations can respond faster and more effectively – ***World Bank***

Barriers to AI adoption



Psychosocial Barriers



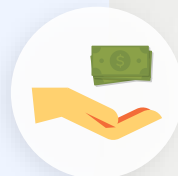
Ethical Barriers



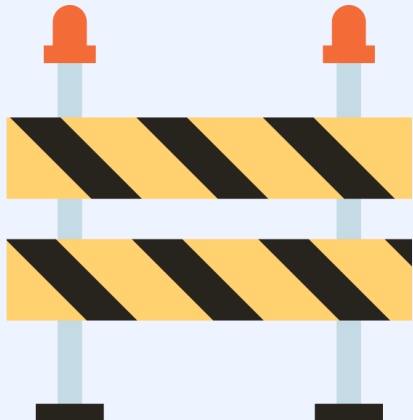
Resource and Infrastructure Barriers



Organizational Culture Barriers



Funding and Sustainability Barriers



What is Artificial Intelligence?

AI is technology that enables computers to perform tasks that normally require human intelligence, such as analyzing information, recognizing patterns, and making suggestions.

Key AI Concepts

- **Machine Learning (ML)** finds patterns in data and improves over time
- **Natural Language Processing (NLP)** helps AI understand and generate human language
- **Large Language Models (LLMs)** are trained on massive datasets to generate text
- **Deep Learning** uses layered neural networks to handle complex tasks

Where AI Is Today



2022

ChatGPT launches —
AI goes mainstream



2024

78% of organizations
adopt AI



2025

Agentic AI arrives —
AI that plans and acts



2026

88% of organizations
use AI regularly

McKinsey Global Survey, "The State of AI in 2025," November 2025

<https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/quantumblack/our-insights/the-state-of-ai>

What AI Can Do — and What It Can't

✓ Good At

- Drafting emails, letters, and reports
- Summarizing long documents
- Translating into other languages
- Spotting patterns in data
- Brainstorming and generating ideas
- Repetitive tasks at scale

✗ Not Good At

- Verifying facts and statistics
- Making ethical or mission-driven decisions
- Understanding your community context
- Showing empathy or building relationships
- Protecting private or sensitive data
- Replacing human judgment or expertise



Today You'll Practice

Rewrite challenge → Fundraising outreach → Responsible AI checkpoint → Emails, letters, grants & translations → Case notes → Leadership summaries & Excel analysis → Quarterly report

How AI Actually Works



Think of AI as a very well-read assistant

The Analogy

Imagine an assistant who has read millions of books, emails, and reports. When you ask a question, it draws on everything it has read to give you the most helpful response. It does not “think” – it predicts what comes next based on patterns.

Three things to remember:

- You give the instructions – AI does the heavy lifting
- Better instructions = Better results
- The first answer is a starting point, not the finish line

AI Foundations



Better Instructions = Better Results

- ① Be specific
- ② Give context and background
- ② Name the audience
- ④ Set the tone and style
- ⑤ List requirements, structure, length
- ⑥ Revise and iterate – always

Think of AI as something you guide – not something that reads your mind

The Art of Better Prompts

“Through multiple cycles of generation, evaluation, and refinement, we can arrive at creative solutions that neither human nor machine could have achieved in isolation.”

— Ethan Mollick, *Co-Intelligence* (2024)

Why Specifics Matter

- Vague prompt = vague output
- Add context, audience, and tone
- Every detail you add = better results

The Iteration Mindset

- First answer = feedback, not final draft
- Review, spot gaps, refine
- It's a conversation, not a command

AI Foundations

✗ Vague Prompt

"Help me plan an event."

What's missing:

- No event type or purpose
- No audience or budget
- No tone, timeline, or deliverable

✓ Specific Prompt

"I'm planning a 200-person outdoor fundraising gala for our animal rescue nonprofit on September 20. Our budget is \$15,000. Draft a detailed timeline from 8 weeks out through event day, including vendor deadlines, volunteer assignments, and a rain contingency plan. Use a friendly, organized tone suitable for sharing with our board."

Hits all 6 foundations:

- | | | |
|-----------|------------|----------------|
| • Task | • Audience | • Requirements |
| • Context | • Tone | • Structure |

Stop Searching, Start Instructing

AI thrives on detail. Brief it like a colleague who's never met your team.

✗ The Old Habit

Search engines trained us to type short, vague phrases and hope for the best.

"Write a donor email."

✓ The New Approach

"Write a warm 175-word email to a past donor who supported after-school programming last year. Invite them to fund summer youth. Grateful, hopeful tone. Include one impact stat."

Every good prompt includes:

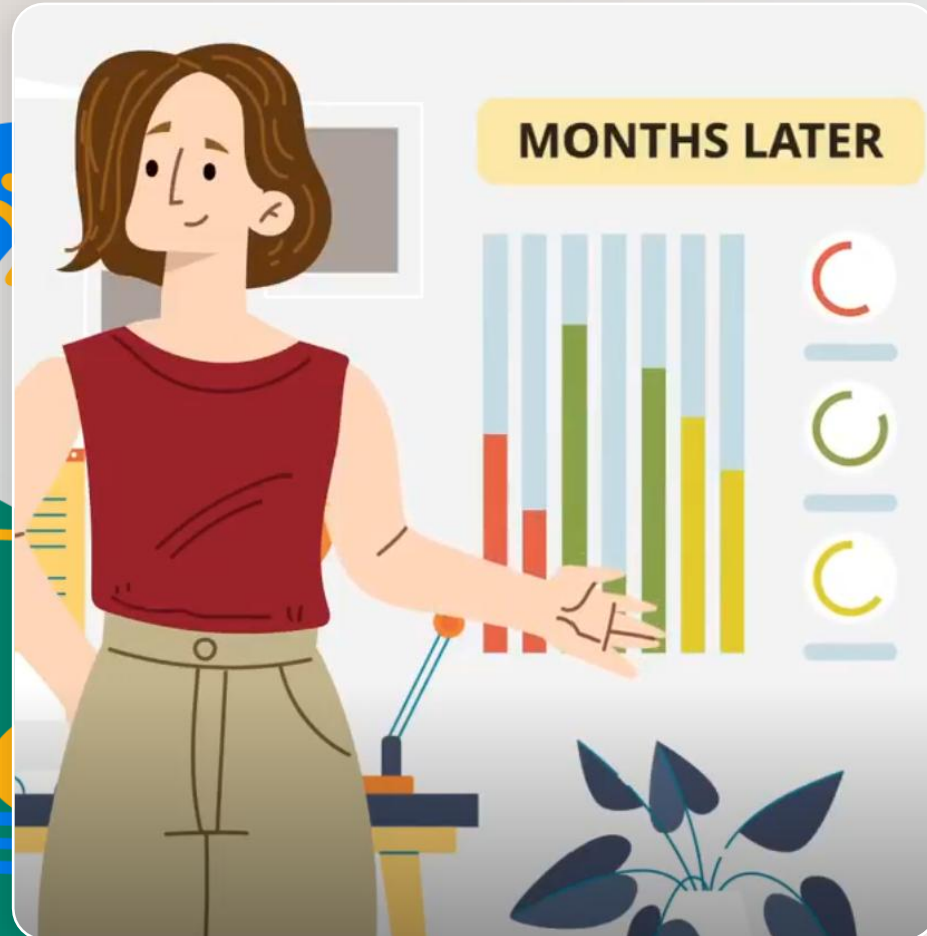
- ✓ **Audience** – Who is this for?
- ✓ **Purpose** – What do you need?
- ✓ **Tone** – How should it sound?
- ✓ **Format** – What shape should it take?

The more context you share, the less you fix afterward.



Accountability

Nonprofits – not machines – are responsible for the impact of AI.



Accountability means:

- Keeping AI systems transparent (not “black boxes”).
- Setting clear policies and processes around AI use.
- Reviewing AI outputs for accuracy, fairness, and safety every time.
- Allowing people to challenge or question AI-generated decisions.
- Ensuring humans remain in control of important decisions.

Responsible AI: What every nonprofit must know

AI creates drafts. Humans create trust.



Always Review AI Output

The first answer is a draft, not the final product. Revise, refine, and check for bias before sharing.



Protect Client Privacy

Never enter real names or identifying information into AI tools.



Verify Facts, Numbers & Translations

AI can state false things confidently. Verify all stats and claims. Have a fluent speaker review translations.



Keep Humans in Control

AI drafts, but humans review, verify, and finalize every decision.

Activity – The Rewrite Challenge

🕒 7 min

👥 Table

📄 Paste both prompts + AI results into shared Notes doc

Step 1 – Pick a vague prompt

Each table picks one: "Write a donor email" • "Plan a volunteer event" • "Summarize our program data" • "Draft a grant letter"

Step 2 – Rewrite it

Add audience, purpose, tone, format, and context. Aim for a full paragraph.

Step 3 – Run both and compare

Paste the vague version into AI, then the specific version. Compare the results side by side.

SHARE-OUT: What single detail made the biggest difference in the AI's output?

Don't Stop at One Prompt

Chain prompts together – each answer powers the next

Use AI's first answer as the starting point for your next request.

Prompt 1 – Gather

"Summarize 3-year trends in youth mentoring: Retention, academic gains, and community impact. 150 words."



Prompt 2 – Apply

"Use that summary to draft a 200-word funder letter for our mentoring program. Confident, data-backed tone. Lead with the strongest stat."

One prompt finds the facts. The next puts them to work.

- Gather or summarize first, then feed that output into your next prompt
- Think of it as a conversation, not a single question





Time to Practice

Now let's move from prompting basics into real nonprofit work.



Demo: AI in Action

Watch what happens when you give AI clear, specific instructions

SAMPLE PROMPT

"I work for Sunshine Community Services, a nonprofit that provides after-school tutoring and mentorship for underserved youth in the Seattle metro area. We are hosting our annual fundraising gala on Saturday, October 17, 2026 from 6:00–9:00 PM at the Seattle Aquarium. Tickets are \$75 per person and tables of 8 are \$500. Draft a warm, professional email invitation for our donor mailing list. Highlight our impact this year: 240 students served, 92% grade improvement rate, and 15 new mentor partnerships. Include a clear call to action with a link to purchase tickets at sunshineservices.org/gala."

✓ Why this prompt works:

- Names the organization, mission, and audience
- Includes specific date, time, venue, and pricing
- Provides real impact data and sets the tone



Case Management

One of the biggest opportunities for AI in nonprofits is reducing administrative workload.



Demo: Case Note – Housing Stabilization

Example: Housing Stabilization Case Note

Client attended case management meeting. Reported ongoing financial stress due to reduced work hours. Two weeks behind on rent. Case manager reviewed eviction prevention resources, assisted with rental assistance application, discussed budgeting strategies. Client motivated to maintain housing for herself and two children.

Other Case Note Types to Practice:

- Workforce Development
- Family Services
- Youth Mentoring
- Behavioral Health
- Senior Services
- Homeless Outreach

AI-Generated Next Steps:

- Submit rental assistance docs by May 28
- Follow up with landlord re: Payment plan
- Schedule workforce development referral
- Check assistance application status in 1 week



Activity – Case Notes to Action Items

🕒 7 min

👤 Solo



Paste case summary + action items into Notes doc

PROMPT – Copy & paste, then customize

Using de-identified case notes:

‘Client missed two appointments, recently started part-time work, needs childcare support, asked about transportation assistance, wants help updating resume.’ Create a neutral case summary, next-steps checklist, referral categories, and a short supervisor update.

ITERATE – Run it, then refine with this

Rewrite the supervisor update as a brief email to a partner agency requesting a warm referral for childcare and transportation services.

SHARE-OUT: How did AI help you organize messy notes into clear next steps?



Fundraising & Outreach

Let's put those prompting skills to work on real fundraising scenarios.



Activity – Volunteer Email

🕒 7 min

👥 Table

📄 Paste final email into shared Notes doc

PROMPT – Copy & paste, then customize

You're a volunteer relations coordinator at a community nonprofit. Draft a personalized email inviting volunteers from previous events to an annual leadership program. Include the volunteer's past contributions, program dates and benefits, and use a warm, motivating tone.

ITERATE – Run it, then refine with this

Make it more personal: add a specific detail about the volunteer's past event, mention them by name, include a clear registration link, and tighten to under 200 words.

SHARE-OUT: What details made the biggest difference in personalization?

Activity – Donation Letter

🕒 7 min

👤 Solo



Paste final letter into shared Notes doc

PROMPT – Copy & paste, then customize

Draft a donation request letter for a nonprofit that serves at-risk youth. Include one specific impact statistic, a personal story hook, and a clear ask with suggested giving levels (\$25, \$50, \$100). Keep the tone grateful and urgent.

ITERATE – Run it, then refine with this

Adjust for a long-time donor who gave last year. Make it feel like a personal update, not a mass mailing. Add a P.S. line with a deadline.

SHARE-OUT: How did the tone shift between a general ask and a personal update?



Grant Writing

Let's move from donor outreach into fundraising and grant communication.



DEMO – Grant Application

Grants for Growth: Nonprofit Microgrant

<https://www.veritycu.com/grants-nonprofit>

Ask AI to answer the questions based on your company

*Verify AI results on every answer and manually reword as needed





Communications & Translations

Now let's look at one of the most powerful community-facing uses of AI.



Activity – AI Translation

🕒 5 min

👥 Table

📄 Paste original + translation into Notes doc

PROMPT – Copy & paste, then customize

Translate this to [Spanish/Vietnamese/Somali]. Keep the tone warm and accessible.

Dear Community Members,

We provide: Food assistance – housing support – transportation help – youth mentoring.
Contact us for support.

ITERATE – Run it, then refine with this

Now adapt the same message as a text message (under 160 characters) and a social media post (under 280 characters) in the same language.

SHARE-OUT: What context did you add for the translation to make sense culturally?

Demo: One Message, Multiple Languages

DEMO

English (Original)

Dear Community Members,

Hope Harbor Community Outreach is here to support families facing food insecurity, housing instability, and financial hardship.

We provide:

- Food assistance
- Housing support
- Transportation assistance
- Youth mentoring
- Workforce development

Services available throughout King County.

Spanish Translation

Estimados miembros de la comunidad:

Hope Harbor está aquí para apoyar a las familias que enfrentan inseguridad alimentaria, inestabilidad de vivienda y dificultades financieras...

Vietnamese Translation

Kính gửi cộng đồng,

Hope Harbor luôn sẵn sàng hỗ trợ các gia đình đang gặp khó khăn về thực phẩm, nhà ở và tài chính...

Always Review Before Publishing

AI translations should **ALWAYS** be reviewed by a fluent human speaker before public release.



Cultural nuance matters



Community trust matters



Legal wording matters



AI can still make mistakes



Tone matters



Annual Report Demo

Finally, let's see how AI can organize and communicate large amounts of information.



Activity – Analyze excel data

🕒 10 min

👤 Table

📁 Paste leadership summary + key findings into Notes doc

PROMPT – Copy & paste, then customize before pressing Enter

I have 3 months of nonprofit data across 3 Excel sheet, January, February and March.

On another sheet, make an income analysis of how many households' income went up or down and poverty level category changes, summarize which outcomes improved. Make charts and graphs

Use the Excel file provided

SHARE-OUT: What trends surprised you? What would you investigate next?

Activity – Presentation to Board Members

🕒 12 min

👤 Solo

📁 Paste board summary into shared Notes doc

PROMPT – Copy & paste, then customize before pressing Enter

- Create a PowerPoint presentation for a quarterly board meeting.
- Make pictures, speaker notes and bullet points on every slide.
- Suggest visuals or charts.
- Show an overview of each month
- Show Program outcomes and impact
- Challenges or risks and priorities for next quarter

Tone: Clear, professional, and appropriate for board members Keep slides concise and focused on key insights.

ITERATE – Run it, then refine it

SHARE-OUT: What got cut when you condensed – and did that make it stronger?

Demo: AI Builds an Annual Report

DEMO

Live Demo: Paste notes → Full presentation

Paste a grant narrative, annual report, or outcome data.
Then ask AI to create a complete presentation:

- Organization overview & mission
- Community need & program overview
- Impact statistics with chart ideas
- Success stories & volunteer contributions
- Donor impact & future goals
- Call to action & speaker notes

AI creates drafts. Humans create trust.

Verify data, add branding, personalize messaging, finalize strategy.



Share-Out

Table discussion – 4–5 tables share what they learned



What did you change in your AI request?



What got better when you were more specific?



Where would you use this next week?

Your Week-One Challenge

You earned your badge! 🏆

Try this before next Friday:

1. Pick ONE **repetitive task** from your week
2. **Try AI on it** – Be specific about context, audience, and tone
3. **Iterate** – Improve the first result
4. **Share** what worked with a colleague

Thank You

AI for Nonprofits | June 2, 2026

Instructor

Jeremy Nathan

*Nonprofits know how to help people.
AI helps more people access that help.*

We love
feedback

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AI for Nonprofits

Credential

Earn a professional certificate from Microsoft, LinkedIn, and NetHope to help you build AI expertise through role-based learning grounded in responsible, effective AI application.



Changemaker Fellowship

Community

Apply to join a global cohort of AI champions focused on moving from ideas to impact with peer learning, dedicated implementation support from AI experts, and recognition for your leadership.



Live and on-demand training

Capacity building

Develop practical skills through training using real-world nonprofit scenarios, expert insights, and clear guidance that simplifies your workflows and helps you do more with ease.

aka.ms/MicrosoftElevateforChangemakers

